

work there. For instance, TCS offers an optional 30 days of paid leave to woman associates post-maternity leave, along with 'leave without pay' based on requirement and eligibility. "We run a TCS-sponsored online maternity care programme that offers expectant mothers and fathers-to-be expert guidance and counselling through the maternity continuum. We also run TCS Rebegin, an opportunity for women professionals to rejoin the workforce," he says, adding that the initiative benefits women professionals who have taken a career break and helps them return to the corporate world.

TCS has also introduced a flexible work policy on the maternity

continuum along with other benefits that extend beyond women employees. "TCS health insurance now includes medical insurance for same-sex partners and reimbursement for sex reassignment surgery. Further, LGBTQ+ associates may add their partners as dependents in their insurance policy," he elaborates, while adding that there is complete non-tolerance of unlawful, direct and indirect discrimination, harassment and victimisation.

With a workforce of 613,974 till March 2023, whose average age hovers around 31.4 years across 153 nationalities, Lakkad says that strategic talent development is a key focus area, which has led them to cre-

ate a culture of lifelong learning. The company's 'One HR' structure has helped the management focus on associates' well-being, business continuity, compliance and fuelled growth. "Our reimagined HR strategy positions us well to continue delivering outstanding associate experience," he says.

Lakkad believes that the company's philosophy of empowering employees, its talent retention policies and a decentralised organisational structure have helped it with succession planning as well. "TCS's philosophy... has resulted in a large and deep bench of leadership talent that enables robust succession planning and continuity and consistency in strategy," he explains.

TCS has also invested deeply in reskilling its talent, and this, says Lakkad, has established outstanding learning ecosystems. For instance, close to 400,000 associates are a part of its flagship Elevate programme that offers learning across different grades—including prescription-based learning at junior levels and subscription-based learning at mid and senior levels. This helps associates create a brand for themselves and for TCS to create growth and transformation consultants. "We have intensified our focus on equipping our mid-level managers with future-relevant specialised skills to be the growth drivers for our customers. More than 83 per cent of the target associate pool are already participating and close to 60 per cent are certified in various market-relevant skills," says Lakkad.

That, and more, is what makes TCS stand out among its peers. **BT**

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KEY HR INITIATIVES

► **TCS has invested deeply in reskilling its internal talent, established quality learning ecosystems and reinvented learning approaches**

► **As part of its approach to well-being, TCS provides comprehensive health insurance, occupational health centres, peri-**

odic health screening, financial well-being, emotional well-being through TCS Cares, one-on-one counselling, suicide prevention and more

► **Recognising the need for a diverse and inclusive workforce, TCS now has more than 200,000 women in its ranks**

► **TCS Rebegin is an opportunity for women professionals to rejoin the workforce, which encourages their professional and technical aspirations**

► **Close to 400,000 associates are part of its Elevate programme that offers learning to associates across levels**



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